

"And do not be
like those who forgot
Allah, so He made
them forget themselves."

— Qur'an 59:19



THE *DARK STAIN* ON TODAY'S SOCIETY

*A Wake-Up Call for a Lost Generation
and a Return to Allah*

BY

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"Before you point at the darkness around you, ask whether you are carrying a light."

TITLE PAGE

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DEDICATION

This book is dedicated to every young person searching for purpose, every family trying to stay together, and every heart that wants to return to Allah and become a source of good in society.

INTRODUCTION — WHY THIS BOOK?

Every generation has problems. Our generation is not the first to struggle, and it will not be the last. But we are living in a time when good and bad can reach us faster than ever before. This book is not written to attack modern life or to say that everyone is bad. It is written to ask difficult questions about the direction of society. What happens when people become more connected but less caring? What happens when popularity becomes more important than character? What happens when money becomes more important than honesty? What happens when young people have more information but less guidance? These questions matter because society is made of people. If people change, society changes. The pages ahead are written in simple language so that important ideas can be understood by everyone. The goal is not only to make you read. The goal is to make you think, feel and act. As you read, do not only think about other people. Let this book become a mirror for you.

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CHAPTER 1 — A SOCIETY LOSING ITS WAY

A society can have tall buildings, fast internet and modern cars and still have a serious problem. The real strength of a society is not only what it builds outside. It is also what it builds inside people.

Today, we can speak to someone on the other side of the world in seconds. We can find information with a few taps. We can watch lessons from great teachers. These are blessings. But progress outside us does not automatically mean progress inside us.

Many people are becoming tired, worried and spiritually empty. Some have money but no peace. Some have hundreds of online friends but feel lonely. Some are always busy but do not know what they are busy for.

This is one of the dark stains of our time: we can become very good at living in the world while becoming poor at living with purpose.

Allah says: “Corruption has appeared throughout the land and sea because of what people’s hands have earned...” (Qur'an 30:41)

This verse should make us look at ourselves. It is easy to say, “Society is bad.” It is harder to ask, “What am I doing that makes society better or worse?”

A lost society does not become lost in one morning. It happens slowly. Respect becomes less important. Honesty becomes negotiable. Family time becomes rare. Prayer becomes delayed. Wrong becomes entertainment.

But there is still hope. A society can return to goodness when its people return to Allah and begin changing themselves.

CHAPTER 2 — WHEN WRONG BECOMES NORMAL

One of the most dangerous things that can happen to a person is getting used to what is wrong.

At first, a lie may make someone feel uncomfortable. After telling many lies, the person may stop feeling anything. At first, gossip may feel shameful. Later, it becomes normal conversation. Cheating may begin as one small act, but repeated cheating can become a way of life.

The Prophet Muhammad ﷺ warned us about lying, breaking promises and betraying trusts. In Sahih al-Bukhari 33, these are mentioned among the signs of hypocrisy.

Think about a white shirt. One small stain may look harmless. But if the stain is ignored and more dirt is added, cleaning becomes harder.

The same can happen to the heart.

We should never say, “Everybody does it, so it must be okay.” Something does not become right because many people do it.

Real strength is choosing what is right when the wrong choice is easier.

If you have made mistakes, do not give up. Stop, repent and start again. The goal is not to pretend that you have never fallen. The goal is to keep returning to Allah whenever you fall.

“The signs of a hypocrite are three...” — Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, Sahih al-Bukhari 33

CHAPTER 3 — THE PRISON OF SOCIAL MEDIA

Social media can be useful. It can help us learn, communicate, run businesses and spread good messages. But something useful can become harmful when we stop controlling it.

Many people now feel pressure to look perfect. They see pictures of expensive clothes, beautiful places, successful businesses and happy families. They may begin to think, “Everyone is enjoying life except me.”

But social media usually shows only a small part of a person's life.

The danger becomes greater when we measure our worth by likes, comments and followers.

Ask yourself: Who am I when nobody is watching?

Do I do good only when people can see me? Do I post everything because I want praise?
Do I become angry when people do not notice me?

The Prophet ﷺ taught that actions are judged by intentions. This is a powerful lesson in the age of social media.

Use your phone as a tool, not as your master. Let it help you learn, work and communicate. But give your heart time away from the screen.

Sometimes the best notification is silence. Sometimes the best place to look is not at a screen, but at the Qur'an.

“Actions are judged by intentions.” — Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, reported in Sahih al-Bukhari and Sahih Muslim

CHAPTER 4 — WHEN MONEY BECOMES EVERYTHING

Money is not evil. We need money to live, study, support families and help others. Islam allows lawful wealth. The problem begins when money becomes the main reason for living.

A person may start thinking, “If I am rich, I am important. If I am poor, I am nobody.”

That is a dangerous idea.

A person's value is not decided by his car, clothes, house or bank account. Character matters. Faith matters. Honesty matters. Kindness matters.

The Prophet ﷺ said: “The world is a prison-house for a believer and Paradise for a non-believer.” (Sahih Muslim 2956)

This teaches us that this world is temporary. We can enjoy its lawful blessings, but we should never forget the Hereafter.

Money can buy a comfortable bed, but it cannot guarantee peaceful sleep. It can buy a large house, but it cannot automatically create a loving family.

Work hard. Earn honestly. Build a good future. But do not sell your character to get money.

CHAPTER 5 — THE BREAKING OF THE FAMILY

The family is one of the first places where a person learns love, respect, patience and responsibility.

When families are strong, society becomes stronger. When families are constantly fighting, ignoring one another or living without care, the damage can spread.

Today, many families face a strange problem: people can be physically close but emotionally far apart.

A family may sit in one room, yet everyone is looking at a different screen. A parent may be working all day. A child may spend hours online looking for advice from strangers.

The solution is not to throw away technology. The solution is balance.

Put the phone down sometimes. Eat together. Ask your parents how their day went. Listen to your children. Visit relatives. Check on an elderly family member. Say “thank you.” Say “I am sorry.” Forgive.

The Prophet ﷺ taught that every person is a shepherd and is responsible for those under their care.

Responsibility begins at home.

If we want better communities, we should build better homes. And if we want better homes, we must begin with better hearts.

“Each of you is a shepherd and each of you is responsible for his flock.” — Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, Sahih al-Bukhari and Sahih Muslim

CHAPTER 6 — THE LOST YOUTH

Young people face pressures that previous generations did not face in the same way. A young person can now carry thousands of opinions in a phone.

Friends can influence us. Videos can influence us. Trends can influence us. Sometimes people follow something simply because everyone else is doing it.

But popularity does not make something right.

A young person needs a clear purpose. Without purpose, time can disappear into entertainment, endless scrolling and activities that bring no real benefit.

The Prophet ﷺ taught the importance of using one's youth before old age and one's health before sickness. Time is a gift that does not return.

Young people should learn useful skills, study seriously, protect their prayers, choose good friends and respect their parents.

Do not be ashamed of having values. Do not think good character makes you weak.

You do not have to follow every trend. You do not have to prove yourself to everyone.

Your life has a purpose. Build it carefully.

CHAPTER 7 — WHEN KNOWLEDGE DOES NOT CHANGE THE HEART

We live in a time when information is everywhere. You can watch lectures, read books and search for answers within seconds.

But information is not the same as wisdom.

A person can know many facts and still be rude. Someone can speak about religion and still cheat people. Someone can win arguments and still have a proud heart.

Real knowledge should change how we behave.

Ask yourself: What has my knowledge done to me?

Has it made me more patient? More honest? More respectful? More helpful? More humble?

The great scholars of Islam always reminded people that knowledge should lead to action and good character.

Learning without practice can become like carrying a map without ever taking the journey.

A society needs educated people, but it also needs people who can be trusted. Knowledge and character must grow together.

CHAPTER 8 — THE DEATH OF COMPASSION

One of the saddest signs of a troubled society is when people stop caring about other people's pain.

Sometimes we see a person struggling and walk past without asking if they need help. Sometimes someone's mistake becomes entertainment online. Sometimes people laugh at another person's weakness because they want attention.

But every person has a story we may not know.

The Qur'an repeatedly teaches mercy, justice and care for others. The Prophet ﷺ was known for mercy toward people, children, neighbours and those who were struggling.

Compassion does not always require money.

You can listen to someone. You can share food. You can help an elderly person. You can encourage a student. You can defend someone who is being treated unfairly. You can simply speak kindly.

A small act of kindness may be forgotten by the world but remembered by Allah.

A good society is not one where everybody is rich. It is one where people care when another person is hurting.

CHAPTER 9 — THE HIDDEN SELF

There are two versions of many people: the person others see and the person they become when nobody is watching.

This is why sincerity is so important.

It is easy to look religious, successful or respectable in front of people. The harder test comes when nobody can praise us.

Would we still tell the truth if lying would make us money? Would we still pray if nobody knew? Would we still return something that did not belong to us if nobody could catch us? Would we still help someone if our name would never be mentioned?

These questions show us what is really inside.

The Prophet ﷺ taught that Allah looks at our hearts and deeds, not simply at our outward appearance.

We should therefore work on the hidden self.

Fix what people cannot see. Ask Allah to clean your heart from pride, jealousy, dishonesty and hatred.

A clean heart is a greater achievement than an impressive image.

CHAPTER 10 — THE FORGOTTEN HEREAFTER

One reason people become careless is that they forget that life has an ending.

When a person thinks only about today, he may choose pleasure over responsibility. But when he remembers the Hereafter, his choices become different.

Islam teaches that this life is temporary and that every person will return to Allah.

Remembering the Hereafter does not mean refusing to enjoy lawful things. It means putting them in the right place.

Study, work, build a family, earn money and enjoy good food. But remember that none of these things will last forever.

One day, our possessions will remain behind. Our titles will remain behind. Our popularity will remain behind.

What follows us are our deeds.

Before speaking, think. Before cheating, think. Before hurting someone, think. Before wasting another day, think.

The reminder of the Hereafter can bring life back to a heart that has become careless.

CHAPTER 11 — THE QUR'AN'S WARNING AND HOPE

The Qur'an does not hide the problems of humanity. It tells us about injustice, pride, greed, corruption and people who turned away from guidance.

But the Qur'an also gives hope.

Allah says: "Indeed, Allah will not change the condition of a people until they change what is in themselves." (Qur'an 13:11)

This verse teaches responsibility. We cannot simply sit and complain.

If we want a better society, we need better people. If we want better people, hearts must change.

The Qur'an also teaches us not to lose hope in Allah's mercy. A person who has made mistakes can repent. A family that has become distant can rebuild. A young person who has gone in the wrong direction can return.

The Qur'an is not only a book to be read during special occasions. It is guidance for life.

Read it slowly. Think about its message. Ask what it wants you to change.

CHAPTER 12 — LESSONS FROM THE PROPHET ﷺ

The life of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ gives us a practical example of good character.

He taught people to be truthful, trustworthy, merciful and just. He cared about neighbours. He encouraged kindness to parents and relatives. He warned against pride and oppression.

His message was not simply about words. It was about changing people.

One strong lesson from his life is that leadership begins with character.

You do not need to be a famous leader to make a difference. You can lead your younger brother by being a good example. You can lead your friends by refusing to cheat. You can lead your classmates by helping someone who is struggling.

The Prophet ﷺ also taught us to control anger, forgive and treat people with dignity.

Imagine what would happen if families followed these teachings seriously.

Homes would become more peaceful. Schools would become more honest. Businesses would become more trustworthy. Communities would become more caring.

Change can begin with one Sunnah practiced sincerely.

CHAPTER 13 — WISDOM FROM THE SCHOLARS

The scholars of Islam spent their lives trying to understand the faith and improve the human heart.

Imam Al-Hasan al-Basri رحمه الله was known for reminding people about sincerity, the shortness of life and preparation for the Hereafter. His message was simple: do not let this temporary world make you forget Allah.

Imam Al-Ghazali رحمه الله wrote deeply about the heart, character and the danger of being controlled by desires. His work reminds us that changing society requires changing the person inside the society.

The lesson from the scholars is not simply to collect quotations. It is to live by good advice.

A beautiful saying has little value if it never changes our behaviour.

So when you hear good advice, ask: “What will I do differently after hearing this?”

The greatest wisdom is wisdom that becomes action.

CHAPTER 14 — CAN SOCIETY BE CHANGED?

Yes. But change does not usually begin with a huge crowd. It begins with individuals.

If you want society to become honest, start by becoming honest.

If you want people to respect parents, show respect to your own parents.

If you want less gossip, stop spreading gossip.

If you want young people to become better, become a better example.

If you want people to care for the poor, begin by helping someone near you.

Do not wait for everyone else to change first.

Allah says that He does not change the condition of a people until they change what is within themselves. That means personal reform matters.

Change also needs patience. Bad habits can take time to leave. Communities can take time to heal.

Do not become discouraged because the results are slow.

A farmer does not plant a seed today and demand a tree tomorrow. He waters it, protects it and waits.

Good change is like that.

CHAPTER 15 — START WITH YOURSELF

After everything we have discussed, one question remains: What will you do now?

It is easy to close this book and say, “Society is really bad.” But that is not the purpose of this book.

The real question is: “What will I change in myself?”

Maybe you need to improve your prayer. Maybe you need to stop lying. Maybe you need to control your tongue. Maybe you need to repair a relationship. Maybe you need to spend less time on your phone. Maybe you need to stop following people who lead you away from what is good.

Start with one thing.

Do not wait until you become perfect. Start while you are still struggling.

Allah's mercy is greater than our mistakes.

A dark room does not become bright because people complain about the darkness. It becomes bright when someone brings a light.

Be that light.

Be honest when others lie. Be kind when others are harsh. Be patient when anger is easy. Help when nobody is watching. Pray when the world distracts you. Forgive when revenge feels easier.

Before you blame society, look at your own heart.

Before you point at the darkness, ask whether you are carrying a light.

The dark stain on today's society does not have to be permanent.

A heart can return. A family can heal. A young person can change. A community can rise. And a society can awaken.

The change can begin today.

It can begin with you.

FINAL REMINDER: Do not leave this book with only knowledge. Leave it with one decision to become better.

QUR'AN & HADITH REFERENCES

- Qur'an 30:41 — corruption on land and sea and the call to return to righteousness.
- Qur'an 13:11 — change begins with what people change within themselves.
- Sahih al-Bukhari 33 — lying, breaking promises and betraying trusts.
- Sahih Muslim 2956 — the temporary nature of this world for the believer.
- Sahih Muslim — the virtue of strength and goodness in the believer.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Abdul Sammed Takiyudeen writes with the aim of encouraging young people and ordinary readers to think deeply about faith, character, responsibility and the condition of society. This book is written in simple English so that its message can reach a wide audience.

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AUTHOR'S NOTE

The Qur'anic translations in this book are presented for meaning and easy reading. Readers are encouraged to consult the Arabic Qur'an, reliable translations and qualified scholars for deeper study.